

Isolating using the Path selection

Isolation using the Path selection is identical to that of the Lasso/Free hand selection tool. The only difference is that the movement of the path is a little rugged and stacked compared to the Lasso tool. On the other hand, the Path tool lets you restore the path using the path tab in the Layer Box.

The best and the worst part of the path tool is that it allows you to change/edit every point that you join to create the path. This sometimes turns out to be a headache. For example, suppose you are working with a complex image and have created many joints to complete the selection. And, by mistake, you messed up and forgot to join the points, yet you continued with the job. In this case, in the end, the selection will be incomplete and you will have to find the missing joint. Another plus for the path tool is that it's pretty easy to use and all the joints/points you create are visible right through the end.

Isolating using the Fuzzy/Colour selection

The Fuzzy and Colour selections are not just another bunch of selection tools. Both of them are very efficient and offer quick results for isolating images. Both also have a pretty similar approach. The Colour selection is better than the Fuzzy selection, as the former offers a wide selection irrespective of layers, while the latter offers selections limited to the layer and colour tone.

Both these tools let you isolate images from a single toned background. If the background has multiple tones, then you can carry out the isolation steps a number of times, selecting different colour tones and then removing them. These tools come in handy while creating buttons, logos, etc. and if you want to turn an image background transparent. Since transparent backgrounds

offer more flexibility over coloured backgrounds, these tools come into play a lot.

For this assignment, open the Colour Select Raw.png image from the LFY CD and grab the Colour selection tool. Now select the background, which is white in this case. I have kept the background simple for quicker learning. Once the background is selected, head to *Colour* → *Colour to Alpha* and with default settings, click OK. Notice that the background is now transparent. You can always wipe away the remnants of colour near the border using the Blur tool. Save the image in png (Portable Network Graphics) and notice the difference. A transparent background image can be used anywhere while an image with a particular background colour will only look good when in the same colour region.

Fuzzy selection works in the same way but for smaller regions. We have already discussed the foreground selection tool in the third part of the series on the Gimp, published in the September issue. So that's it for now—we have covered almost every aspect of selection tools. We will be working with them throughout the series in a limited or in a sophisticated manner; but for now we are done with the selection. The next tutorial will be a bit of surprise; it could be related to something high definition or a wallpaper. I have included PTS with two windows (Multiple Rectangle Raw.png and the final output). Try getting that result using a tip hidden in this article. Do stay tuned, and do not forget to send in your queries and suggestions! 

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